



Calling In & Requesting Time Off

Job Readiness • what to say, when to say it

FOR STAFF • 30-MINUTE SESSION

Purpose: Practice appropriate notice, phone calls, and time-off requests.

Materials: Packet; optional partner role-play.

Easy flow: 5 min compare emergency vs planned request • 15 min scripts • 5 min role-play • 5 min reflection.

Planned or Last-Minute?

Dentist appointment next month

☐ Request ahead ☐ Call workplace now ☐ Not a good reason to miss work ☐ It depends

Wake up vomiting before a food-service shift

☐ Request ahead ☐ Call workplace now ☐ Not a good reason to miss work ☐ It depends

Friend invites you somewhere tomorrow

☐ Request ahead ☐ Call workplace now ☐ Not a good reason to miss work ☐ It depends

Family graduation in six weeks

☐ Request ahead ☐ Call workplace now ☐ Not a good reason to miss work ☐ It depends

Ride cancels 20 minutes before work

☐ Request ahead ☐ Call workplace now ☐ Not a good reason to miss work ☐ It depends

You forgot you were scheduled

☐ Request ahead ☐ Call workplace now ☐ Not a good reason to miss work ☐ It depends

A Simple Call-In Script

“Hi, this is _____. I am scheduled today from ____ to _____. I am calling because _____. I wanted to let you know as soon as possible. What do I need to do next?”

Practice Cards

You have a fever before your shift.

What I would say: _____

What I would say: _____

What I would say: _____

How much notice am I giving?

You need next Friday off for a medical appointment.

What I would say: _____

What I would say: _____

What I would say: _____

How much notice am I giving?

Your car will not start and your backup ride is 30 minutes away.

What I would say: _____

What I would say: _____

What I would say: _____

How much notice am I giving?

You want Saturday off for a concert, but the schedule is already posted.

What I would say: _____

What I would say: _____

What I would say: _____

How much notice am I giving?



Get Them Talking

- Does calling in correctly guarantee you get the day off?
- Why does early notice matter?
- What's the difference between an emergency and poor planning?